Required versus optional practice quizzes in introductory economics: a randomised field experiment

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Abstract

We randomised 412 students to required or optional practice quizzes. Of these, 368 completed the course. Final-exam scores did not differ between the groups.

1. Methods

Design: individually randomised field experiment. Participants: 412 students enrolled in an introductory economics course; 368 (89%) completed the course and the final exam. Intervention: practice quizzes counted towards the grade (required) or were optional. Outcome: final-exam score (0-100).

2. Results

There was no significant difference in final-exam scores (mean difference 0.8 points, 95% CI -1.9 to 3.5).

3. Limitations

The study was underpowered to detect effects smaller than about 3 points, and 11% of enrolled students did not complete the course.

Fictional paper generated to test evidence-table extraction. Authors, journal, data and results are invented.